



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Vanessa's on an emotional roller coaster.



Learning Outcome

Describe characteristics of different people and their jobs.

Ask your partner:

- Do you use a diary?
- Where do you express your private feelings and emotions?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a diary entry.
- I can say what I was doing when something else happened.
- I can report about actions, events or places.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa writes in her diary about her relationship with Marco. Why does she think Marco was acting like a **jerk***?

* A "jerk" is an obnoxious or rude person.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Diary,

I have so many emotions bottled up inside. Marco is amazing in so many ways. We went to the movies last week to see *Dinner at Mickey's*. I have never laughed so hard in my life. I wasn't laughing though when Marco stumbled up the stairs and spilt popcorn all over me! We grabbed some ice cream from a street vendor and Marco invited me over to his apartment. He showed me his great taste in furniture and accessories. While I was admiring his lamp, I found out he has a sister named Francesca. Things were going so well until Marco started making fun of me. He found it hilarious that I thought he painted a Picasso. I was so annoyed and a little embarrassed. He's so annoying! He better make this up to me.

Vanessa



**Let's Practice!**

What were you doing when you watched the movie?

Instructions: Select the use of the Past Continuous tense or Past tense in each sentence.

1. I wasn't laughing though when Marco stumbled up the stairs and spilt popcorn all over me!
2. While I was admiring his lamp, I found out he has a sister named Francesca.
3. Things were going so well until Marco started making fun of me.

**Let's Practice!**

Vanessa is on an emotional roller coaster. Marco's behavior is so confusing!

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

went / found / jumped / grabbed /
laughed / can't / isn't / showed / was

1. I _____ to the movies last week to see *Dinner at Mickey's*.
2. He _____ it hilarious that I thought he painted a Picasso.
3. We _____ some ice-cream from a street vendor and Marco invited me to his apartment.
4. I have never _____ so hard in my life.
5. I _____ so annoyed and a little embarrassed.
6. He _____ me his great taste in furniture and accessories.





Extension Activity

Now, it's time to write a diary entry about an event. What happened?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write an 80-100 word diary entry about an event in your life.
- Include the Simple Past tense and Past Continuous tense.
- Include information on people, events and places.
- Use informal words and phrases.
- Read your diary entry aloud to a partner or family member.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a diary entry about an event in my life.

☐ ☐

I include information about people, places and events.

☐ ☐

I use informal words and phrases.

☐ ☐

I read my diary entry aloud to a partner or family member.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to stumble** (verb): to hit your foot on something when you are walking or running so that you fall or almost fall
e.g. Marco stumbled in the movie theatre and spilled popcorn all over Vanessa.
- **bottled up** (expression): to be filled with emotion but unable to express it
e.g. Vanessa has so many bottled up emotions.
- **taste** (noun): the ability to choose what is attractive or appropriate
e.g. Marco has great taste in furniture.
- **make this up** (expression): to improve a situation in the future
e.g. He better make this up to me.
- **to reflect** (verb): to think carefully about something
e.g. I wanted to reflect on Marco's behavior.





Learning Points

Past Tense and Past Continuous Tense

You use the Past Continuous tense to talk about something that was happening at a specific time in the past.

You often use the Past Continuous tense together with the Simple Past tense.

The Past Continuous talks about a longer 'background' action.

The Simple Past talks about a shorter event that happened in the middle of, or interrupted, the longer event.

You use the words **when** and **while** before the longer action.

Examples:

- *While I was admiring his lamp, I found out he has a sister named Francesca.*
- *Things were going so well.*
- *He grabbed some ice cream from a street vendor.*
- *He invited me over to his apartment.*

